PRE-PURCHASE INSPECTION CHECKLIST

Mercedes-Benz G 55 AMG

1999–2012 · W463 · AMG 5.4 V8

BOXYTRUCKS

CHECK BEFORE YOU BUY

- [ ] **Is it really an AMG?**
  Plenty of G 500s and G 550s have been dressed as AMGs. Check the VIN and the data card, not the badges.
- [ ] **Naturally aspirated or supercharged?**
  US 2002–2004 trucks are naturally aspirated; 2005–2011 are Kompressors. Make sure the model year, VIN and engine all match the price.
- [ ] **Heat soak and the intercooler pump**
  On a Kompressor, ask when the intercooler pump was replaced. A truck that pulls hard when cold and goes flat when hot is the classic symptom.
- [ ] **Listen at idle**
  Vibration or an RPM-dependent chirp on the M113 points to the harmonic balancer. Don't drive far on a failing one.
- [ ] **Mounts and suspension**
  Commenters on German Cars For Sale Blog advise checking engine and transmission mounts and suspension wear. With 700 Nm going through them, mounts wear out faster.
- [ ] **Test all three lockers**
  Engage the centre, rear and front locks on loose ground. Lockers that 'were never used' by the last owner often don't work.
- [ ] **Rust, even on the fancy one**
  Owners warn G 55s rust like any G, especially near the coast. Check the tailgate's lower edge, door bottoms, sills and rear frame tubes.
- [ ] **Gear oil behind the front wheels**
  Oil on the inner wheels or the large AMG calipers means front axle seals, and possibly contaminated brakes.

YEARS TO KNOW

2002–04	BEWARE	Early US trucks share the G 500's electrical gremlins (seat motors, window regulators, door-lock actuators). Handsome Motors says they were mostly gone by 2005–06; CarGurus counts early G 55s among the least reliable US Gs

RECALLS TO ASK ABOUT

- [ ] **Fuel return hose permeation**
  2004–2005 · NHTSA 05V378

IS IT THE REAL THING?

- [ ] **Front turn signals behind grille covers (FMVSS 108)**
  2002–2010 · NHTSA 10V366
- [ ] **Passenger airbag molding strip**
  2011 · NHTSA 12V380

- [ ] **VIN characters 4–8**
  Bring a Trailer examples decoded with NHTSA's vPIC tool: 2003 G 55 = WDCYR46E..., 2005–2008 G 55 Kompressor = WDCYR71E..., 2011 G 55 = WDCYC7BF.... A same-year G 500 reads WDCYR49E... and a 2010–2014 G 550 WDCYC3HF..., so a 'G 55' with a G 500/G 550 VIN is a dress-up.
- [ ] **Model year (10th character)**
  The 10th character gives the model year (e.g. 3 = 2003, 5 = 2005, 8 = 2008, B = 2011). US G 55s from 2002–2004 are naturally aspirated; 2005–2011 are Kompressors.
- [ ] **Supercharger and intercooler**
  A Kompressor has a supercharger on top of the V8 and an intercooler circuit with its own pump. No supercharger means a 2002–2004 truck or not a G 55.
- [ ] **2009-on visual cues**
  From 2009, the G 55 has a three-fin grille, KOMPRESSOR lettering under the V8 badge on the front wings and titanium-grey wheels.
- [ ] **Grand Edition**
  The 2005 Grand Edition has Allanite Grey Magno paint, brushed-aluminium trim strips with 'Grand Edition' lettering and illuminated Grand Edition door sills.

NOTES

From the full guide at https://boxytrucks.com/models/g-class/g55-amg/, with sources. Recalls follow the VIN: check at nhtsa.gov/recalls. General information only, not a professional inspection; see boxytrucks.com/about/disclaimer/. © BoxyTrucks